



The Safe Environment for Elderly

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Outline

- Introduction:
- Definition of environmental safety
- Environmental hazards to elder person
 - Physical hazards.
 - Biological hazards
 - Chemical injuries & hazards.
 - Thermal hazards
 - Psychosocial hazards.
- Role of nurse to eliminating environmental hazards.

Objectives

At the end of this lecture every candidate will be able to:

- Recognize meaning of safe environment
- List components of safe environment
- List characteristics of safe environment.
- Explain nurse roles to maintain safe environment for elderly client

Introduction

- The need for safety is one of our most basic human needs. Safety is very important for all age group but safety needs are the greatest for young children and the elderly.
- The elderly environment includes all of the many physical and psychosocial factors that influence or affect the life and survival of that elderly.

Definition of environment

- The sum total of all surroundings of a living organism, including natural forces and other living things, which provide conditions for development and growth as well as of danger and damage.



Definition of environmental safety

Environmental safety is the practice of policies and procedures that ensure that a surrounding environment, including work areas, laboratories or facilities, is free of dangers that could cause harm to a person working in those areas. A safe place to work is the key element of environmental safety.

Environmental hazards to elder person

Physical hazards:

- ❖ Lighting
- ❖ colors
- ❖ Floor covering
- ❖ Noise
- ❖ furniture
- ❖ Mobility Aids
- ❖ Bathroom hazards
- ❖ Bedroom hazards
- Kitchen Areas

Biological hazards

Associated with working with animals, people, or infectious plant materials during day care facilities may expose to biological hazards.

Types of things exposed include: Blood and other body fluids

- Fungi
- Plants
- Insect bites
- Animal and bird droppings
- Bacteria and viruses

Chemical injuries & hazards

- The over dose of medication is the most common cause of chemical hazards for elder people
- Cleaning products: may use in the cleaning of the home such as toilet cleaners, disinfectants, chlorine.

Thermal hazards

- Because of loss of sense the elder people may need care and be more safety from any hot temperature as boiling water, also the temperature of the room should be warm not cold to avoid hypothermia and it's complication

Psychosocial hazards

- Psychosocial hazards are related to the relationship with other persons caregiver and social interaction that the elder person at risk of social isolation.
- Exploitation
- Abuse (verbal , physical, sexual and psychological) violence

Role of nurse to eliminating environmental hazards

Assessment:

- ☒ It is necessary to assess all departments of the older home to ensure the safety for all elder person such as indoor (bedroom bathroom, kitchen) and outdoor (stairways, porches, balconies & garage doors).

Nursing Intervention

- Keep walk path to entrance free of mess, rubbish and fix irregular areas on walk path.
- Improve elderly vision through regular eye appointments, proper lighting and well lighted areas for walking reduce glare and use bright color mark kinds at change in floor heights.
- prevent slips by :
 - Use non-skid material under all rugs and adhere rug /carpet to prevent trips place small rugs only in water traffic areas.
 - Clean up water spills immediately.

- Wear proper shoes to prevent slips and improve balance.
- Use grab rails or bars where recommended typically at stairs / steps and tub/shower area & color label where change in height of floor are present.
- Ensure that the elderly client stay physically fit to prevent an onset of weakness and have good balance.
- Exercise in areas where there are a lot of other exercisers which will keep elderly client motivated.

*Thank you
for your cooperation
and good luck!*

